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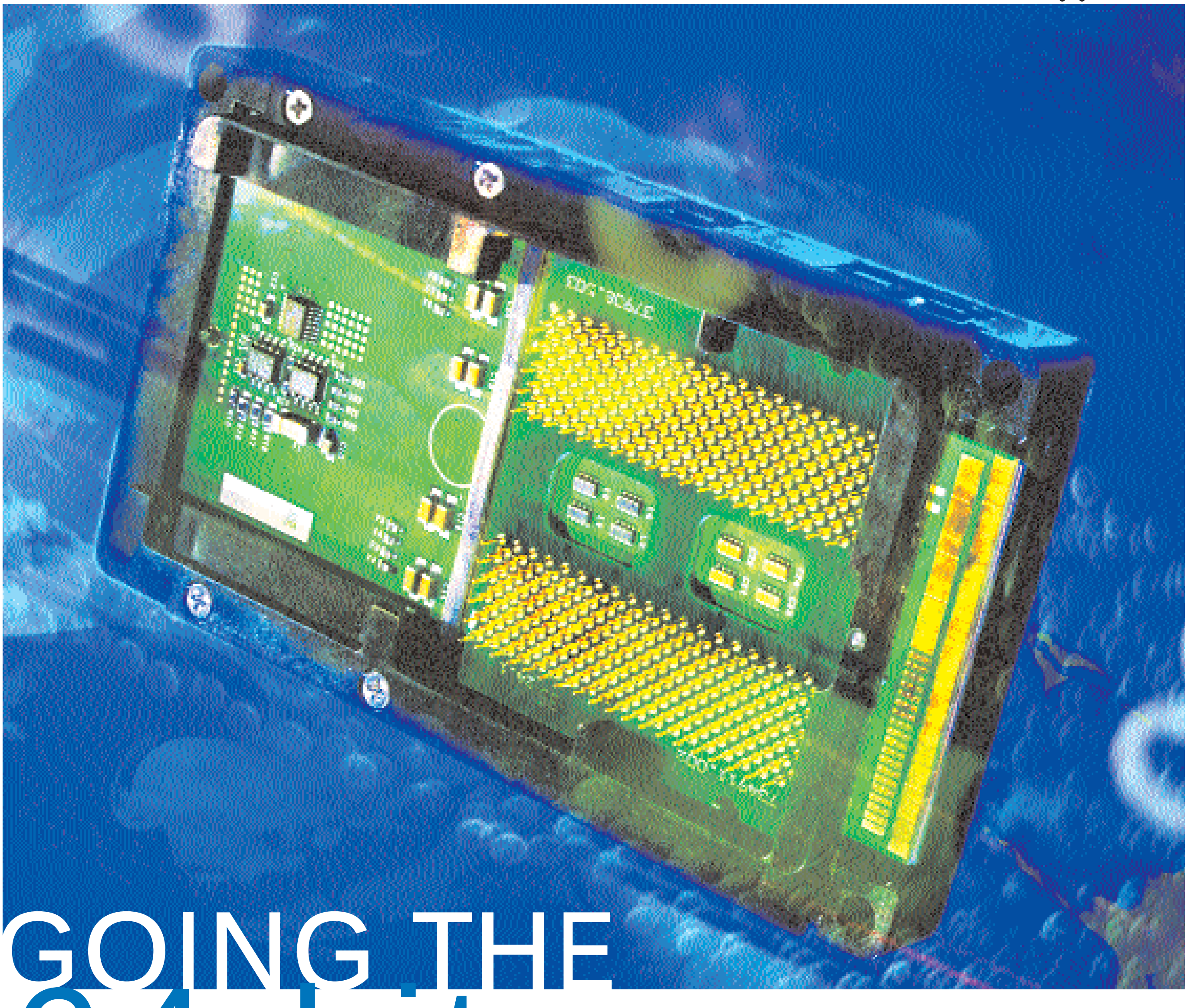

GOING THE 64-bit way

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Products that boast of the 'bigger, better, faster' syndrome keep coming to the fore regularly, each promising to outdo its predecessor. The most recent technological development is Intel and Hewlett-Packard teaming up to offer a new processor named 'Itanium'. This processor has been co-invented by HP, produced by Intel and is targeted at the most demanding server applications, especially useful in today's age where such Web-servers and enterprise computing needs are on an exponential rise.

The Itanium is successor to the Xeon, which was quite a popular choice for server applications. While the Xeon was built around a 32-bit RISC (Reduced Instruction Set Computing) architecture, the Itanium ushers in a new age of processing as it is built around a 64-bit architecture. These new technologies are collectively referred to as IA-64 (Intel Architecture-64) and EPIC (Explicitly Parallel Instruction Computing). Itanium consists of about 25.4 million transistors and will be fabricated on the 0.18-micron process while later releases will be created on the 0.13-micron process.

Announcing the arrival of the path breaker for all future processors—the Itanium

The new technology

Intel is known for its wide range of processors for desktops, servers and laptops. Up till now all processors were built on an IA-32 architecture including the Celerons, the Pentium 4 and the Xeon. These processors were made to run 32-bit applications on operating systems such as Win-